

1943, April 6

The following is a faithful transcription of the photo-copy of the type-written original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

SAINT BONAVENTURE MONASTERY
DETROIT, MICHIGAN

April 6, 1943

Lieutenant Owen Joseph Brady
Camp Berkerley, Texas

My Dear Nephew;

God bless you and yours. And before I forget, let me congratulate you on your 24th anniversary. I'll try to reach you by the end of the week if not interrupted too frequently; so that you may have a reminder on the solemnity corresponding to that on which you were born, - Passion Sunday.

I hope you are well and keeping the faith; for in these days of unrest and of international turmoil when atheism - the positive climax of insanity - is so rampant, it is no trifle to keep in mind the great purpose of our creation and to live consistently, as for God. Ah, how often has not that second question of the little catechism we used to study while romping with grazing cattle on the slopes and wooded lowlands of pioneer west Wisconsin, come back to me! "Why did God make you?" And the beautiful answer: "To know God..."!!!

If according to philosophy: "To know is to appreciate." may we not say that, to know is to love the good; is to reject the bad, the wicked; is to adore the Divine? Could we think of a higher purpose?What hope this should inspire when we remember that the mercy of God is above all His works! What an outlook for poor sinners! What a sublime horizon if, "Hope is the very soul of happiness here" and the purpose of the rational creature TO KNOW GOD, which covers everything, be kept in mind! Hence, thanks be to Divine Providence.

God made me to know Him. O what a bless'd aim!
To love Him and serve Him, sure rests in the same.
Its "Heaven Begun" for the grateful, on earth;
To treasure aright ! ! ! Highest Heaven its Worth.

You are possibly surprized at the above introductory details; and it did strike me as remarkable that a letter from your dear Mother, together with the first and last that my little namesake B. ever sent me, should unexpectedly fall into my hands on the eve of the "New Baby" Owen Joseph's twenty-fourth birthday. From letter dated "May 2, 1919." - first anniversary of your dear GrandMa Casey's + .. Dear Br. Bernard; Well, thank God all my sorrow has most certainly turned into joy; for we are again happy over the birth of our forth child little darling Owen Joseph....." and she adds a P.S. to B's letter:

Original in Possession of:

Owen J. Brady
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